TIMUR KHAZIROV

Technical Designer

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Open to relocation · Remote-capable

PROFILE

Gameplay Designer with 5+ years of professional experience developing multiplayer and live-service games in Unreal Engine and Unity.

Experienced in feature ownership from design through release, gameplay prototyping using Blueprints and C++, balancing combat, progression and economy systems, and collaborating closely with engineering teams.

Strong technical background allows rapid gameplay iteration, implementation of prototypes and development of internal production tools.

Led junior designers and contributed to commercial PC and mobile titles

CORE COMPETENCIES

Weapon & Combat Mechanics • In-Engine Implementation (Blueprints/C++) • Rapid Prototyping & Iteration • Systems Integration • Vehicle & Locomotion Prototyping • Design & Technical Documentation • Cross-department Collaboration • Toolkit/Workflow Improvement • Mentoring & Feedback • Balance and Economy • Systemic Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design	Weapon & Combat Mechanics, Gameplay Systems Integration, Rapid Prototyping & Iteration, Vehicle/Locomotion Prototyping, Player Progression, Economy Design, Design & Technical Documentation
Unreal Engine	UE4/UE5, Blueprints (visual scripting), C++ gameplay programming, Gameplay Tags, Enhanced Input, Animation Blueprints, Behavior Trees, AI Controllers, State Machines, Data Tables, Primary Data Assets, NavMesh, Gameplay Debugging
Unity	C#, MonoBehaviour, ScriptableObjects, gameplay implementation & prototyping
Programming	C++, C#, Python
Tools	Git, Bitbucket, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Rider, Visual Studio, Excel/Google Sheets

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Game Designer — GFAGAMES

Nov 2024 — Present

Project: PIONER (Steam, released) — multiplayer open-world survival shooter, Unreal Engine

- Owned the full feature flow end-to-end — from concept to in-engine implementation — for the hip-fire spread system, dynamic crosshair, automatic reload system, and a full rework of the perk system
- Balanced a set of interconnected systems (combat, economy, progression, loot, crafting, vendor pricing, boss parameters)
- Created and integrated new gameplay mechanics into existing systems while retaining full functionality — including the hip-fire spread system, dynamic crosshair, automatic reload system, and a full rework of the perk system — implemented directly in Blueprints.
- Prototyped and iterated on weapon, armor, consumable and enemy mechanics as ongoing live content, based on internal testing and player feedback.
- Worked hands-on inside existing Behavior Trees and C++ systems to fix gameplay issues via Blueprints — built technical understanding of how existing mechanics interact before modifying them.
- Wrote and maintained design/technical documentation (balance tables, feature specs) and reviewed design documents as part of mentoring junior designers.
- Built a C++ tool that parses loot logic and exports spawn-point data to CSV, improving the team's content/balance toolkit.
- Collaborated closely with engineers and artists to take new weapons and systems from concept to shipped, live content.

Technical Game Designer — 101XP

Dec 2022 — Nov 2024

Projects: The Braves (Steam, released, Unity) and Craft of Survival (Google Play, released)

- Owned gamepad support and player-facing UI/UX flows, and designed hero ability systems from concept through implementation.
- Designed boss encounter variations and balanced enemy difficulty across live content updates.
- Identified a content-integration bottleneck and built an internal automation tool that cut integration time by roughly 5x — direct experience improving a production toolkit.
- Worked daily with programmers, artists and UI artists to ship ongoing live-service content.

QA Specialist — 101XP

May 2021 — Dec 2022

- Games-industry entry point prior to moving into design; built a strong technical understanding of production pipelines, bug triage, and debugging workflows — distinct from, and in addition to, the design experience above.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

UE5 Helicopter Prototype — Vehicle flight model, weapon systems, and control/locomotion tuning built in Blueprint and C++. Personal-project scope. (Completed)

Unity Horde Shooter — COD: Zombies-inspired shooter prototype with enemy AI, in-game shop, wave spawning, and multiple weapons/arenas. github.com/KhazirovTimur/BotArena (Completed)

Tiny Dozzer (Mobile) — Arcade game about a bulldozer clearing trash, built in Unity; previously released on Google Play.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Bauman Moscow State Technical University — Specialist degree (5-year, equivalent to Bachelor's+Master's), Information Security (2022)
- Michigan State University — Introduction to Game Development (certificate)
- Michigan State University — Principles of Game Design (certificate)

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Blender (basic level) • Adobe Photoshop, Premiere • Basic SFX and music creation • Ableton Live, Reaper

LANGUAGES

Russian — Native | English — B2–C1